It is a colorless solution, but changes into red in the presence of dust.

It irritates when exposed on human skin. It is widely used for industrial purposes.

Phenol itself is used (in low concentrations) in mouthwash and as a disinfectant in household cleaners. Phenol used as surgical antiseptic since it kills micro organisms.

3.8 Adhesives

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What will you do when a page of your book is torn accidentally? It can be fixed by using a cello tape. How cello tape works? There is a paste like material in one surface of the cello tape. Have you ever discussed about this material? The paste like substance is called adhesive. It is commonly known as glue, mucilage, or paste. The substances applied to one surface, or both the surfaces of two separate items that binds them together and resists their separation are called **adhesives**.





Adhesives are substances that are used to join two or more components together through attractive forces acting across the interfaces.

A practical experience

Do you notice how puncture of your bicycle is repaired by the shop keeper? He ensures the punctured surfaces are clean, dry and free of dust, and roughens the area around the hole using a metal scraper. He takes an appropriate patch of tyre-tube and applies a suitable adhesive to both the roughened area and to the underside of the patch, apply firm pressure and allows drying completely. Why does he apply pressure? This increases the adhesive capacity at both the surfaces and ensures proper binding.



Types of adhesives

There are two kinds of adhesives, one is natural made from starch and another one is artificial made from chemicals. The one used in puncture shop is an artificial adhesive.

Artificial adhesives may be classified in a variety of ways depending on their utilities. Their forms are paste, liquid, film, pellets, tape.

It is used in various conditions such as hot melt, reactive hot melt, thermo setting, pressure sensitive, and contact.

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